



is set in the dark ages where young girls March 16 and currently has a TRP of 3.27.

joint venture, Real, has suffered because of its faulty distribution system. All new programming has been stopped even as 9X has started selling its time slots for a few Rs 1-2 lakh for half an hour. The real action is at the top. In the past two months, there have been three number one channels and four shows, Colors's *Balika Vadhu*, Star Plus's *Bidaai* and *Yeh Rishta Kya Kehlata Hai* as well as Zee TV's *Agle Janam...*, which have had a shot at the top. Network loyalty is dead and programme loyalty seems destined to follow. What Miditech's Niret Alva calls snacking is the new fun diet. Little wonder then every channel is desperately seeking the next sensation.

308
is the GRP of
Colors, up
from 116 last
year. Star Plus
has fallen
from 321 to
293 in the
same period.

And little wonder then that at a time when India is being accused of selling out to America and the economy is still in the doldrums, *Balika Vadhu* and *Sacch ka Saamna* are the subjects most agitating India's MPs. Both are game-changing shows. The former ratcheted Colors to the top after just nine months while the latter opened to a weekly average TRP (calculated on the basis of reach of the show and time spent on it) of 4.3 and has become a water-cooler regular, celebrating voyeurism at its worst. "Have you thought about other women while getting intimate with your wife?" host Rajeev Khandelwal asks marketing executive Allwyn D'Souza. His answer, "Yes." "Have you ever thought of killing your husband?" Khandelwal asks a seemingly calm homemaker Smita Mathai. Her answer, "Yes" again.

Sacch ka Saamna isn't just one curious case. It's only following the rules of Indian television. If you can't beat them, shock them. With NDTV Imagine's part-exploitation-part empowerment *Rakhi ka Swayamwar* opening with a 4.1 TRP while Sony's *Iss Jungle Se Mujhe*

6%
is the rise
in the
programming
share of
reality shows
on television
since 2008.



SHABBY CHIC Out with the gold, in with the glass. TV's betis believe in less is more and the audience is following. Orders for matching glass bangles in shades of red and green, seen in shows like *Balika Vadhu* and *Agle Janam...*, are being placed. The maang tika, till now ignored, is a hot favourite.

KURTA CALL She might play Vishaka, an aspiring actress on Zee TV's *Chhoti Bahu* but Priyanka Mishra's anrakha kurtas are already a hit. Multi-coloured yokes on red and blue on yellow and green chiffon kurtas with a gota dupatta complete the look.

STYLE QUOTIENT He's bringing the 1950s back. Like a lot of his predecessors, Rajeev Khandelwal on *Sacch ka Saamna* is dressed in a suit all right, but he's sticking his neck out. Styled by Priya Mishra, the actor's ever-changing cravat, set off against the kerchief in his suit pocket, has touched a chord with window dressers. Suit sellers have started dressing their mannequins as Khandelwal. How long before the buyer follows?